

Area of Study 2C – Islam

Overview

This area of study comprises a study in depth of Islam as a lived religion within the United Kingdom and throughout the world, and its beliefs and teachings on life, specifically about the issues of peace and conflict, and crime and punishment.

There are four sections: Islamic Beliefs, Crime and Punishment, Living the Muslim Life and Peace and Conflict.

The significance and importance of the various beliefs, issues and practices to Muslims today should be explored throughout the sections. This should include reference to how the Qur'an informs a Muslim's understanding of the topics and how approaches to the issues are underpinned by philosophical arguments and ethical theory as applicable.

Students will be expected to study Islam within the context of the wider British society, the religious traditions of which are, in the main, Christian. Students should compare and contrast the areas of belief and practice within Islam with Christianity as outlined in the content below.

- Beliefs about the afterlife and their significance (1.8)*
- The practice and significance of worship (3.3)*

Students should recognise that Islam is one of the many religions and world views in Great Britain, which include Buddhism, Hinduism, Judaism, Sikhism and non-religious views such as Humanism and atheism. This knowledge may be applied throughout the assessment of the specified content.

Students should compare and contrast the areas of ethics and/or philosophy within Islam and non-religious views as outlined in the content below.

Students should also recognise that within Islam there may be more than one perspective in the way beliefs and teachings are understood and expressed. Common and divergent views within Islam in the way beliefs and teachings are understood and expressed should be included throughout, including reference to Sunni and Shi'a traditions.

Students should have an understanding of:

1.1	The Six Beliefs of Islam: their nature, history and purpose, including Kitab al-iman 1:4; how they are understood and expressed in Sunni and Shi'a Muslim communities today; the importance of these principles for Muslims.
1.2	The Five Roots of 'Usul ad-Din in Shi'a Islam: Tawhid (oneness of Allah); 'Adl (Divine Justice); Nubuwwah (Prophethood); Imamah (Successors to Muhammad) and Mi'ad (The Day of Judgment and the Resurrection); the nature, history and purpose of the Five Roots with reference to their Qur'anic basis, including Surah 112 (the oneness of Allah); the importance of these principles for different Shi'a communities today, including Sevener and Twelver.
1.3	The nature of Allah: how the characteristics of Allah are shown in the Qur'an and why they are important; Tawhid (oneness), including Surah 16:35–36, immanence, transcendence, omnipotence, beneficence, mercy, fairness and justice, Adalat in Shi'a Islam.
1.4	Risalah: the nature and importance of prophethood for Muslims, including Surah 2:136; what the roles of prophets teach Muslims, exemplified in the lives of Adam, Ibrahim, Isma'il, Musa, Dawud, Isa, and Muhammad.
1.5	Muslim holy books (Kutub) – the nature, history, significance and purpose of Muslim holy books with reference to: the Qur'an; the Tawrat (Torah), including Surah 5:43–48; the Zabur (Psalms), including Surah 4:163–171; the Injil (Gospel), including Surah 57:27; and the Sahifah (Scrolls). Divergent Muslim views about the importance of the holy books in their lives today.
1.6	Malaikah: the nature and importance of angels for Muslims; how angels Jibril, Izra'il and Mika'il are shown in the Quran, including Surah 32:11 and 2:97–98, and their significance for Muslims today.
1.7	al-Qadr: the nature and importance of Predestination for Muslims; how al-Qadr and human freedom relates to the Day of Judgement, including reference to Sahih al-Bukhari 78:685; divergent understandings of predestination in Sunni and Shi'a Islam; the implications of belief in al-Qadr for Muslims today.
1.8*	Akhirah: Muslim teachings about life after death; the nature of judgement, paradise and hell; how they are shown in the Qur'an, including Surah 17:49–72; divergent ways in which Muslim teachings about life after death affect the life of a Muslim today.

Students should have an understanding of:

2.1	Muslim attitudes towards justice: Muslim teachings about the nature of justice and why justice is important for Muslims, including Surah 4:135; Muslim responses to why justice is important for victims; non-religious attitudes (including atheist and Humanist) about why justice is important, regardless of religion and belief, and Muslim responses to these attitudes.
2.2	Muslim attitudes towards crime: Muslim teachings about and responses to the nature, causes and problem of crime, including Surah 16:90–92 and about crime as a distraction from a focus on Allah; what action is taken by Muslim individuals and Muslim groups to end crime, including the Muslim Chaplains Association and the work of the Mosaic Community Trust.
2.3	Muslim teachings about good, evil and suffering: Muslim teachings about the nature of good actions, how they are rewarded, and teachings about the nature of evil actions; non-religious attitudes (including atheist and Humanist) about why people suffer, including believing in religion, and Muslim responses to them; divergent Muslim teachings about why people suffer, including Surah 76.
2.4	Muslim attitudes towards punishment: divergent Muslim teachings and attitudes towards the nature and use of punishment, including Surah 2:178 and 5:44–46 and links to situation ethics; Muslim teachings on why punishment can be regarded as justice and why punishment might be needed in society.
2.5	Muslim attitudes towards the aims of punishment: divergent Muslim attitudes towards each of the aims of punishment (protection, retribution, deterrence and reformation); Qur'anic teachings about punishment, including Surah 4:26–32.
2.6	Muslim teachings about forgiveness: Muslim teachings and responses about the nature and importance of forgiveness, including Surah 64:14; how offenders are forgiven by the community and why this is needed; Muslim responses to the nature and use of restorative justice, and why it is important for criminals.
2.7	Muslim teachings about the treatment of criminals: Muslim teachings about the treatment of criminals, including interpretations of Surah 76:1–12; divergent Muslim attitudes towards the use of torture, human rights, fair trial and trial by jury; the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, which may accept the use of torture if it is for the greater good.
2.8	Muslim attitudes towards the death penalty: the nature and purpose of capital punishment; divergent Muslim teachings about the nature, purpose and arguments surrounding the use of capital punishment, including Sahih Muslim Hadith 16:4152; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes towards the use of capital punishment, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Muslim responses to them.

Students should have an understanding of:

3.1	Ten Obligatory Acts of Shi'a Islam: their nature, history and purpose of the Ten Obligatory Acts; the diversity of practice and importance of Ten Obligatory Acts for Shi'a Muslims today; their basis in the Qur'an, including reference to Surah 9:71–73; divergent understandings of these principles within Sunni Islam, including links with the Five Pillars.
3.2	Shahadah as one of the Five Pillars: the nature, role and significance of Shahadah for Sunni and Shi'a Muslims, including reference to Surah 3:17–21; why reciting Shahadah is important for Muslims, and its place in Muslim practice today.
3.3*	Salah as one of the Five Pillars, including reference to Surah 15:98–99 and 29:45: the nature, history, significance and purpose of Salah for Sunni and Shi'a Muslims, including different ways of understanding them; how Salah is performed, including ablution, times, directions, movements and recitations, in the home and mosque and Jummah prayer.
3.4	Sawm as one of the Five Pillars: the nature, role, significance and purpose of fasting during Ramadan, including Surah 2:183–185; those who are excused from fasting and why. The significance of the Night of Power: the nature, history and purpose of the Night of Power; why Laylat al-Qadr is important for Muslims today.
3.5	Zakah as one of the Five Pillars and Khums: the nature, role, significance and purpose of Zakah and Khums, including Surah 9:58–60 and 8:36–42; why Zakah is important for Sunni Muslims; why Khums is important for Shi'a Muslims; the benefits of receiving Zakah or Khums.
3.6	Hajj as one of the Five Pillars: the nature, role, origins and significance of Hajj, including Surah 2:124–130 and 22:25–30; how Hajj is performed and why Hajj is important for Muslims; benefits and challenges of performing Hajj for Muslims.
3.7	Jihad: the origins, meaning and significance of Jihad in Islam; divergent understandings of Jihad within Islam, including the difference between lesser and greater Jihad; the conditions for declaration of lesser Jihad, including reference to Surah 2:190–194 and 22:39; the importance of Jihad in the life of Muslims.
3.8	The nature, origins, activities, meaning and significance of the celebration/commemoration of Id-ul-Adha, with reference to Surah 37:77–111, and Id-ul-Fitr in Sunni Islam, with reference to their place within Shi'a Islam; and Id-ul-Ghadeer, with reference to Hadith and the interpretation of Surah 5:3, and Ashura in Shi'a Islam, with reference to their place within Sunni Islam.

Students should have an understanding of:

4.1	Muslim attitudes towards peace: Muslim teachings about the nature and importance of peace, including Surah 25:63; Muslim understandings about Islam as a religion of peace and how this may be understood in the life of a Muslim.
4.2	The role of Muslims in peacemaking: Muslim teachings about peacemaking; the importance for Muslims of justice, forgiveness and reconciliation in peacemaking, including Surah 41:31–38; the work of Muslims working for peace today.
4.3	Muslim attitudes to conflict: Muslim teachings and responses to the nature and causes of conflict; Muslim responses to the problems conflict causes within society, including Surah 2:190–195 and links to situation ethics; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes about the role of religion in the causes of conflict and Muslim responses to them.
4.4	Pacifism: divergent Muslim teachings and responses to the nature and history of pacifism, including interpretations of Surah 5:27–30; Muslim teachings about passive resistance and examples of its use within Islam, including elements of the Arab Spring.
4.5	Just War theory: divergent Muslim teachings and responses to the nature and importance of the Just War theory, including reference to Sunni and Shi'a Islam; the conditions of a Just War within Islam, with specific reference to the lesser Jihad, including reference to Surah 4:69–110; divergent opinions on whether a Just War is possible for Muslims today, including the application of ethical theories such as situation ethics.
4.6	Holy War: the nature of a Holy War (Harb al-Maqadis) within Islam; Muslim teachings about war and peace as shown in the Qur'an; divergent Muslim teachings about war, with specific reference to the lesser Jihad, including interpretations of Surah 8:61 and 9:1–14.
4.7	Weapons of mass destruction (WMD): Muslim teaching and responses to the problems and benefits of WMD; Muslim attitudes towards the use of such weapons, including Surah 5:32; non-religious attitudes (including atheist and Humanist) and the application of ethical theories (such as utilitarianism) which support the acquisition of weapons of mass destruction, and Muslim responses to them.
4.8	Issues surrounding conflict: divergent Muslim teachings and responses to the nature of problems involved in conflict – violence, war and terrorism; how Muslims have worked to overcome these issues, including Malik's Muwatta 21.3.10; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) views towards the issues surrounding conflict and Muslim responses to them.